LLM-Based Anomaly Detection in System Logs

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Abstract

A milestone update will be given on how Large Language Models can be used to identify problems in system and network logs. The practical application that will be used is a web application designed using the MongoDB, Express, React, and Node (MERN) stack. The framework that will be used to scan the network logs is called LangChain combined with Claude. The topic number in this syllabus is: 14. LLM-Based Anomaly Detection in System Logs. So far the application has been built with Backend Logging using the Javascript logging Library Winston which so far is able to log backend API requests and responses. LangChain framework has been implemented to some extent and is able to scan logs. However more fine-tuning needs to be done as it is not consistent and there are still bugs and issues with thee Claude API.

CCS Concepts

• **Computing methodologies** → **Natural language processing**; *Neural networks*; • **Security and privacy** → **Intrusion/anomaly detection and malware mitigation**; • **Software and its engineering** → System administration.

Keywords

large language models, anomaly detection, log analysis, system monitoring, LangChain, natural language processing, security analysis, network logs

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1 Introduction and Problem Statement

1.1 Motivation

The motivation for this project is to explore how LLMs can be used to identify problems in system and network logs, which can be a valuable tool for system administrators and security professionals.

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1.2 Significance

The significance of this project is that it can help to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of log analysis, which can lead to faster identification of issues and improved security.

1.3 Objectives

The objectives of this project are to develop a web application that can scan network logs using LangChain and Claude, and to evaluate the performance of the application in identifying anomalies in the logs.

2 Related Work

Recent advances in applying large language models to log analysis have shown promising results.

Egersdoerfer et al. [1] began using LLMs such as ChatGPT for log analysis since they are able to retain context and formulate insightful responses over conversations. These LLMs are able to conduct few-shot and in-context learning with reasoning ability. Previously there were several problems with pre-existing techniques. The first issue was that there was a heavy reliance on expert-labeled logs to discern anomalous patterns. This manual labelling slowed down training. The second issues was that they relied on numeric model prediction based on numeric vector input which is not human readable. This lack of human readability rules out targeted error correction by humans.

Qi et al. [4] introduced LogGPT. This paper explored the use of ChatGPT for log-based anomaly detection. It demonstrated that ChatGPT could be effectively used to identify anomalies in system logs, showing promising results in terms of accuracy and efficiency compared to traditional methods.

Guan et al. [2] introduced LogLLM.Traditional deep-learning methods often struggle to capture semantic information in log messages which are typically organized in natural language. LogLLM employed BERT for extracting semantic vectors from log messages, and uses Llama for classifying log sequences. It also uses a projector to align the vector spaces of BERT and Llama to ensure consistency in understanding log semantics. LogLLM doesn't require log parsers to extraxt templates from logs.

He et al. [3] introduced LLMeLog. This paper introduced a system intended to solve two problems. The first problem is that semantic noise is buried in log events which lead to inevitable gaps between the semantics from the logs and their actual intended meaning. The second problem was that there exists a gap between general semantic embeddings and the specific embedding requirement for anomaly detection tasks. LLMeLog uses LLMs to enrich the content of log events with in-context learning techniques. These enriched logs are then used to fine-tune a pre-trained BERT model. Finally, it trains a transformer-based anomaly detection model with the event representationas produced by this fine-tuned BERT model. F1

scorese exceeded 99 percent and even with using only 10 percent of the labeled data, was still able to achieve an F1 score of 90 percent.

3 Methodology

In order to demonstrate how LLMs can be used to identify problems in system and network logs, a web application will be developed using the MERN stack. The application will then utilize some LLM log frameworks that were developed for LLM log analysis to scan a repository of logs and identify anomalies. The performance of the application will be evaluated using standard evaluation metrics for anomaly detection.

3.1 Techniques

3.2 Evaluation Metrics

4 Preliminary Results

Initial findings with brief analysis.

References

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